

not download e-mails from an external server. Hence, the absence of a dialler does not make much of a difference from the SoHo user's perspective. IMail comes in useful for organisations that have a 24-hour Internet connection as well as a static IP address.

IMail also cannot sort and archive e-mails automatically. With support for just a single domain, it only permits 10 users to be created. On the security front, it lacks features such as anti-virus, host-based screening and POP3-before-SMTP.

The server performed extremely well in the flood test. It accepted all messages at one go, without deferring incoming connections, even though a reviewer accidentally caused the flood test script to execute seven times—which meant 7,000 messages bombarding the IMail server. We skipped the speed and virus tests, since the server lacks the downloading feature.

IMail bundles along additional servers such as LDAP, Calendaring, Whois, etc. It also has a client to help users read e-mails from the IMail server. The server has a browser-based interface that includes admin as well as e-mailing options. Only authorised users can view the admin section.

Overall, IMail is a server that does its job well when used with a dedicated Internet connection. Though free for use with 10 users, it's of no use to those with a dial-up connection.

Price: Free (10 users)
Web site: www.ipswitch.com/products/imail_server

- + Outperformed the rest in the flood test
- Downloading e-mails not possible

CommuniGate Pro		A-
Performance	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Features	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Ease of use	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	

Kerio MailServer 5.7.4

Almost famous...

Kerio MailServer is similar to products such as Kerio Personal Firewall—it starts work immediately upon installation.

In the basic e-mailing category, it lacks important features such as auto-reply and carbon-copy. There's no remote dialler. User screening based on host-name is absent. It also could not assign priority to users. There's no inbuilt anti-virus support, however, you can use any anti-virus software with Kerio as long as its present on the system before you install Kerio.

Kerio lets you monitor the mail server installed at a remote location using its IP address or domain name. Its ability to restrict remote administration only from certain IP addresses is remarkable. In doing so, it further enhances the security of the server.

Another useful feature is creating and storing templates for different types of employee such as customer care executives, accountants, managers, clerks, etc. Thus, you can have templates specifying the settings for the inbox of copy editors, reviewers, etc.

Apart from a conventional interface, Kerio has a browser-based mail interface that shows deleted messages using strike-out lines.



Kerio's login screen lets you monitor the Web server as well as the Kerio mail server

These pretend to be absent from the inbox when queried through telnet on the POP3 port. The messages are deleted only if you click the Expunge button.

Interestingly, this server lacked the 'Leave on Server' feature while downloading e-mails from the external mail server. Hence, you cannot download the same e-mail to two different locations.

To our surprise, the anti-spam feature detected all the 1,000 test messages that we pumped in the flooding test as spam; it's pretty intelligent.

Overall, we found Kerio quite simple to use. It was nearly on par with its contenders in the performance rating. However, it lagged behind due to the lack of a few features.

Price: US\$ 395 (20 users)
Web site: www.kerio.com/kms_home.html

- + Deleted messages appear in strike-out font; user templates
- Lacks host-based screening and integrated anti-virus; no 'Leave on Server' feature

Kerio MailServer 5.7.4		A-
Performance	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Features	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Ease of use	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	

MDaemon

A good daemon

MDaemon differs from CommuniGate Pro in its installation—installation and configuration is through a six-step wizard. This helps the user set up the domain, as well as start the server immediately.

The plus point of the installation is that it compulsorily sets up the domain so that the server gets on with its work. However, it does not detect Windows DNS settings automatically, and asks for it through an input screen.

For a change, this software does not have a browser-based admin interface. Having a real application to manage can be a relief for a system administrator—at the very least, he or she knows whether or not the application is responding. The conventional interface is neatly arranged and grouped into Tools, Stats, Servers, Queued mail, etc.

The greatest advantage is that it provides a status of what's running and what's not. Though the browser-based admin interface is not installed by default, you can do it anytime from within the provided interface.

By default, the anti-virus and LDAP modules are not installed. You need to purchase them separately. The trial pack that we used didn't have these modules. However, MDaemon has an in-built mechanism that tests the mail server using the EICAR test after installing the anti-virus. EICAR (<http://www.eicar.org>) is a globally recognised test. It is used to check whether the anti-virus software is deployed correctly.

Surprisingly, by default, SSL is turned off. So you need to



MDaemon has two administrative modes—one for normal users, and another for the advanced, experienced user